Compass Embodied

Humanoid robots as the body for an AI companion that remembers the person and refuses to make things up, tested in memory care and with adults with developmental disabilities.

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1. The problem

- Today's AI assistants forget between sessions, state wrong facts with confidence, and send private health, school and financial information to third-party servers.
- The people who depend most on being remembered accurately are the ones these assistants fail: a memory-care resident who needs to be called by the name she goes by, whose medicines must never be confused with her roommate's, who calms down for one specific reason that staff learn over months. Adults with developmental and learning disabilities need the same thing: an assistant that keeps their history straight and does not guess.
- Humanoid robots are arriving in homes and facilities now. Inside them is the same forgetful assistant. A body without a trustworthy memory is a liability on a dementia unit.
- Family caregivers carry a household's medical, school and logistical history in their heads. When that person is sick, exhausted or gone, the knowledge is lost.

2. What exists today: Compass

A memory layer for AI agents, built and used daily by one Gulf Coast family for about 18 months, across several generations of AI models.

- **Long-term memory.** The family's history (40 million-plus words of conversation and records) held in several stores: typed long-term memory, semantic search over the full record, and a knowledge graph, with a re-ranking step that picks what to show the assistant each turn.
- **Rules built into the memory.** Never fabricate ("I don't have that; let me check"). Facts are dated and superseded, never deleted, like a nursing chart correction. Medical facts are scoped to the person they belong to. Private-tagged text never enters memory. It fails closed on anything private.
- **Measured safety.** A 93-item family-memory evaluation runs before and after every memory change: 65 of 65 safety items pass, 0 of 93 dead-value leaks (October 24, 2026). A 130-question memory benchmark scores 127 of 130 on the current build. These are internal tests on the family's own data.
- **Where it runs.** On computers the family owns at home (7 NVIDIA DGX Spark and 5 Apple Mac Studio machines) using open-weight local models. Honest limit: the main conversational reasoning

today often runs on a commercial cloud model; the local fleet can run without it and is being built toward full independence.

- **Reachable by** terminal, text message and a phone line. Used for school planning (504 plans, a homeschool transition), medical appointments and records, caregiving logistics and household decisions. In the family it serves a young adult with Fetal Alcohol Spectrum Disorder and essential tremor and a teenager with dyslexia and mild ADHD.

3. What we are building: Compass Embodied

The memory layer above, moved onto a humanoid robot, so the body that stands in the room is driven by an agent that remembers the person and will not invent an answer.

- **Already true:** a 1X NEO humanoid is on order (spring 2026, $200 deposit on a roughly $20,000 unit; plan on record for three units, winter 2026). Not delivered yet. The agent does not run on a robot today; everything below is a plan.
- **The idea on record (April 2026):** a young adult with FASD who cannot reliably pass a driver's exam can pilot a humanoid in her own house. Dignity through embodiment: a capability, not a therapy.
- **Compute stays local.** The robot's memory and reasoning run on hardware the facility or family owns (DGX Spark class, one per robot), not a vendor cloud. Resident data never leaves the building.
- **Why a nurse built it.** The founder is a working medical-surgical float nurse. The no-fabrication rule and the chart-correction rule in the memory came from nursing practice.

4. The research question and the plan

Does an agent that remembers the person and refuses to make things up change outcomes for memory-care residents and adults with developmental disabilities, compared with today's forgetful voice assistants?

- **Aim 1 (months 1–6).** Port the memory layer onto the humanoid. Pass the 93-item safety evaluation on the robot, including a red-team test for cross-person medication leaks (target: zero, as in our internal 0/93).
- **Aim 2 (months 4–15).** A small feasibility pilot at one memory-care community and with 3–5 adults with developmental disabilities (teleoperation plus companion tasks), under IRB approval and informed consent.
- **Aim 3 (months 12–18).** Measure, publish, and release an open-source robot-integration layer. The family memory core stays private.

Outcomes we would measure (plans, not results): agitation episodes; caregiver burden; repeated-question load on staff; medication-fact errors across people; resident and family trust; time-on-task for teleoperated tasks by disabled pilots.

Candidate partners, all still to be approached: University of South Alabama College of Nursing / USA Health; Alabama Council on Developmental Disabilities; a Baldwin County memory-care community.

5. Team, open-source work, and honest limits

Chad Hurley, RN, founder. Medical-surgical float nurse at a Level 1 trauma center on the Gulf Coast (2022–now); earlier Thomas Hospital (Infirmary Health) and oncology/neuro nursing at Ascension Providence, where he was one of the first frontline nurses vaccinated for COVID-19. Four DAISY Awards for Extraordinary Nurses and a Nursing Excellence Award. Before nursing, built and sold five companies. Self-taught builder. Accelerated BSN, University of Mobile, 2019. USPTO utility patent application 19/223,294 (filed May 30, 2025; pending). Will move to PRN nursing status before any award requiring majority effort.

Public open-source work (GitHub): pd-bridge (~150 stars; CUDA prefill on NVIDIA to Metal decode on Apple Silicon over 10GbE; a 700,630-token prompt end-to-end in 11 min 26 s) · zigmem (Apache-2.0; one-binary memory for local LLM agents, supersede-never-delete, household scoping of medical facts) · microagent (Apache-2.0; caretaker for a self-hosted memory stack) · lasermemory · credited contributor to TensorFold.

What we do not have yet: no robot delivered; no pilot site, IRB, publications, university partner or letters of support; no outside users; no revenue; no employees; no prior grants. Single-member Alabama LLC formed October 25, 2026.

Budget logic for a funded program: humanoid units (2–6, ~$20K each) · on-site local compute (one DGX Spark class box per robot plus a spare, ~$4K each) · founder effort · a robotics/assistive-technology engineer · a clinical research coordinator at the pilot site · memory-safety evaluation and red-team testing · pilot-site costs and participant/caregiver compensation · IRB and consent work · dissemination and the open-source integration layer.

Mission: "No one in this family will ever fear running out of time." Public line: private, honest AI that stays with a family for years and helps caregivers, built by a working nurse.